

SJAA Ephemeris Bulletin

February 2025

Bulletin Debut

Today, we are proud to introduce a new, monthly, installment of The Ephemeris, which we are calling the "Ephemeris Bulletin!"

The Bulletin seeks to provide more timely information than the more detailed, quarterly newsletter. In these pages, we will highlight things like open leadership positions, volunteer opportunities, and time-sensitive announcements. I expect that things like "Volunteer Opportunities" and "Announcements" will be fixtures every month, and this column, along with its neighbor to my right, will vary from month to month. Small features like a short editorial, or an observing highlight, will rotate in and out of the more *ephemeral* sections.

Oh, and did I mention the calendar? Flip the page for a calendar of events and observing highlights.

Welcome to The Bulletin. Enjoy!

Carl Svensson
Vice-President
Ephemeris Editor

Open Positions

Hands-On Imaging Glenn Newell has announced his intent to step away from the Hands-On Imaging program. Glenn has provided a wealth of resources for seasoned and beginning astrophotographers alike, and we sincerely thank him for all of his contributions in this area!

Now, it's YOUR TURN to step up and help run one of the club's most valuable offerings. The Hands-On Imaging program offers two types of events: Public Workshops, and Astrophotography Field Clinics.

The Public Workshops offer members of the public the chance to learn the basic mechanics of astrophotography. It has historically had a great presentation that gives an overview of astrophotography, along with a working rig that attendees can connect their cameras to. These are typically held two times a quarter.

The Astrophotography Field Clinic is a members-only event, held once

a quarter, where imagers can bring their rig to a dark(ish) sky site, and get personalized help with any questions or issues they might have. These are a great opportunity for imagers to gather and help each other out.

In addition to the logistics of running these events, the ideal candidate would be a seasoned astrophotographer themselves, so as to be able to provide appropriate guidance at the events. They would also be willing to become an OSA docent, or otherwise have access to a good dark site to host the members-only events. The responsibilities may certainly be divided among a team of volunteers, but the position-holder will be the one responsible for the success of this program.

Please contact the volunteer coordinator (volunteerchair@sjaa.net) if you are interested in applying!

Volunteer Opportunities

There are many volunteer opportunities in SJAA! While we love having seasoned experts in our volunteer ranks, we happily welcome enthusiastic beginners, too. Please do not hesitate to reach out to the volunteer coordinator (volunteerchair@sjaa.net) to inquire about opportunities. Below are a few examples of programs that could use help:

Astro 101 We can always use more content and more presenters to share our library of presentations with the public. A volunteer would be put into the rotation of presenters at our public events.

Ephemeris Want to help produce the official publication of the SJAA? A volunteer here would help with finding and creating original content that showcases the club's activities, and relevant events in the astro community. Play reporter by attending SJAA events, and writing about them in our quarterly newsletter!

In-Town Star Party (ITSP) Held monthly, ITSP is our Hogue Park star party. It is open to the public, and volunteers bring their stargazing equipment to show sights to the public.

Announcements

Election season is here! It is time to elect our board members and officers for the year. You have just a few short days left to vote for this year's board members. Each board member serves a two-year term, with half of the members up for re-election every year in February. Officers (president, vice-president, treasurer, and secretary) hold one-year terms, and are elected by the board. Every SJAA member can nominate and vote on board members. SJAA Members can also nominate other members for the officer positions.

Board members meet monthly, and vote on important SJAA business, like approving initiatives and expenses. Officers hold specialized roles according to their position. All of these folks work together to provide leadership for the club, and define its direction and activities.

Check your inbox for voting and nomination instructions.



SJAA February 2025

Sunday	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday
						1 Mendoza Ranch Stargazing 5:00PM Triple Conjunction (Venus, Moon, Saturn)  15%
2 Solar Sunday 1:30PM Loaner Exchange 1:30PM  Fix-It 1:30PM 25%	3  36%	4 Clyde Tombaugh Born (1906)  47%	5 Moon Occults Pleiades First Quarter Moon 12:03AM  59%	6  70%	7  80%	8 Centaurid Meteor Shower  88%
9 Mars 0.8° from Moon  94%	10  98%	11  99%	12 Full Snow Moon 5:54AM  100%	13  99%	14  97%	15 Board Meeting 6:00PM Member Recognition 7:30PM  92% Galileo Born (1564)
16 Venus at Peak Brightness  86%	17 Spica 0.3° North of Moon  79%	18 Imaging SIG Meeting 7:30PM  71%	19 Nicolas Copernicus Born (1473)  61%	20 Third Quarter Moon 9:34AM Grand Alignment Begins  52%	21 Astro 101 6:30PM In-Town Star Party 7:15PM  42% Antares 0.4° N of Moon	22 Starry Nights Star Party at RCDO 6:30PM  32%
23  22%	24  14%	25 Mercury Meets Saturn  7%	26  2%	27 New Moon 4:46PM  0%	28  1%	